

Charles Harless

Software Engineering Manager

charles@harless.net | 818-288-5313 | Los Angeles, CA
<https://www.linkedin.com/in/charless> | <https://ceharless.github.io/>

Engineering Leadership | Web & Mobile Applications | Cloud & Media Platforms

Highlights

- Engineering professional with 15+ years expertise in managing and scaling engineering teams
- Knowledgeable of web, mobile, and cloud platforms delivering reliable and scalable systems
- Successfully launched Disney Movies Anywhere with over 20M+ users with 99.9% uptime
- Reduced engineering backlog by up to 75% & increased team morale by 50%
- Achieved 15% cost reduction in infrastructure through automation

Professional Experience

Computer Science Instructor

UCLA Extension, Los Angeles, CA

August 2023 - Present

- Instructed Java, Web Applications, and Data Structures courses
- Received 4.7/5.0 instructor rating from students based on teaching real-world examples

Software Engineering Manager

Brightcove Inc., Boston, MA

January 2023 - June 2023

- Directed 14 engineers across 2 teams to develop AWS-based media and web applications
- Improved release frequency by 20% via process enhancements and automation
- Eliminated 75% of engineering backlog via capacity planning and prioritization
- Enhanced developer engagement by 40% via individualized growth plans and mentoring

Software Development Manager

Amazon.com Inc., Culver City, CA

January 2021 - June 2022

- Supervised 7 engineers to develop media applications with 25+ backend services
- Decreased time-to-market by 15% via iterative delivery, delegation, and accountability
- Coordinated security updates of 2,000+ applications to attain 100% compliance in 1 week
- Established development programs to increase team morale and engagement by 50%

Technical Lead

NBCUniversal Media, LLC, Universal City, CA

April 2016 - December 2020

- Modernized architectural vision for enterprise platforms serving 23,000+ internal users
- Advised engineering team on modernization of portals to increase workforce productivity by 10%
- Authored coding standards to increase quality and reliability of software releases by 15%

Principal Software Engineer

Sage Software Inc., Irvine, CA

May 2015 - March 2016

- Created a cross-platform mobile framework that reduced time-to-market by 20%
- Evaluated cutting-edge technologies like blockchain and facial recognition

Technical Lead

The Walt Disney Company, Burbank, CA

November 2011 - April 2015

- Launched Disney Movies Anywhere platform serving 20M+ users with 99.9% uptime
- Guided team of 15 developers to design multi-platform streaming applications with Java
- Developed high availability REST API services to support millions of daily transactions
- Collaborated with product and operations teams to improve reliability and performance

Senior Software Engineer

The Walt Disney Company, Glendale, CA

December 2005 - October 2011

- Defined application architecture to increase platform scalability by 20%
- Designed semantic data models to improve reuse and system integration

Core Competencies

- **Leadership:** Team Building, Coaching & Mentorship, Career Development, Roadmap Planning, Agile Development, Stakeholder Management, Resource Planning
- **Architecture:** AWS, Distributed Systems, System Design, Scalability & Performance, Microservices, Web Services, CI/CD Pipelines
- **Technology:** Java, Spring, Node.js, JavaScript/TypeScript, MongoDB, MySQL, GitHub, REST

Education

- Master of Science Degree, Computer Science, University of California Los Angeles
- Bachelor of Science Degree, Computer Science, University of Alabama

Certifications

- Certified ScrumMaster, Scrum Alliance
- Certified Scrum Product Owner, Scrum Alliance
- Generative AI Fundamentals Certificate, Databricks